her force. Man or woman, no one would be spared, she pointed out. She added that there certainly would not be any unjustified arrests to harass them, but then their criminal activities would in no way be condoned.

This warning was backed up by immediate action. A number of spot arrests were made daily and many suspicious characters were sent out of Delhi. Such action had an electric effect upon the people and the large turnout at the next public meeting was a good indicator of this effect. The women again represented the more vociferous segment here. They admitted that they indulged in criminal activities like drug peddling but simultaneously asked as to what alternative did they have? They lived in such poverty that they had to resort to such means to ensure even one square meal for their children. What suggestions was the DCP (North) going to offer these hapless women so that their children would not starve? What answer did she have to their problems? Here was a matter of ethics that could counteract the noblest of intentions.

The assistant commissioner police, D. L. Kashyap, and station house officer, M. D. Mehta, assured them that the police would extend to them all help but that they must first establish their bona fides. Thus was a pact of understanding and mutual trust born that day. But such things are easier said than done. However, as with most of her good intentioned commitments, help was not far to seek. A philanthropist from Delhi, Padam Sen Gupta, offered generous help in the form of sewing machines for the women of the Yamuna Pushta cluster. With festive fervour a tailoring school for all of them was started. The very first job entrusted to these women was the stitching of hundreds of green shirts for so that the porters of Delhi's busiest commercial hub could be easily identified. Needless to say, the number of women drug peddlers and petty criminals started to decline drastically. Little did Kiran know that this innovative crime prevention work would be the harbinger of the birth of the Navjyoti India Foundation, which would institutionalize all her path-breaking crime prevention measures and much more. And that she would dedicate literally all her life to various causes as they came up in her life.

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Such has been the hallmark of Kiran's commitment to crime prevention. All her work has been tempered by humanistic considerations and is based on ground realities. It is only for these reasons that the community responds to her appeals for help in furthering her people-oriented programmes.